Dean E. Phillips

Full-stack development lead bringing agentic AI to how teams ship

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SUMMARY

I'm a developer and team lead with 20 years of production software in .NET, Java, and Angular, across defense, payroll, mortgage, energy, and banking. I've led teams of three to 25 engineers, broken monoliths into microservices, and moved CI/CD pipelines to DevSecOps. Since 2025 I've been bringing agentic AI into delivery: first for development teams at work, and now through a multi-agent pipeline that builds, tests, and ships my own iPhone and Android app.

SKILLS

AI and agentic	Claude Code, Codex, multi-agent orchestration, MCP, custom skills and plugins, BMAD, LangChain, OpenAI API, GitHub Copilot, prompt engineering
Languages	C#, ASP.NET, .NET Core, Java, Spring, Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Node, Angular, Vue, jQuery, HTML, CSS
Architecture	Microservices, REST, RabbitMQ, CQRS, Domain-Driven Design, Clean Architecture, microfrontends, Backend-for-Frontend, threat modeling
Cloud and DevOps	Azure, Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, Docker, CI/CD, SonarQube, OWASP Dependency-Check, Trivy, Semgrep, GitHub rulesets, Git, NPM
Data and testing	SQL, Dapper, NHibernate, Hibernate/JPA, unit and integration testing, Playwright, Cypress, BDD with Gherkin

PROJECT

RepBunny Independent, iPhone and Android app 2026 - Present

- **Shipped a mobile app with an AI-first workflow:** a strength training log for iPhone and Android (Vue 3, TypeScript, Capacitor) with all data kept on the phone. Built alongside a full-time job: first commit to TestFlight in under three weeks.
- **Designed a multi-agent delivery pipeline on Claude Code:** an hourly GitHub Actions dispatcher starts cloud agent lanes that each take the highest-value issue from a scored backlog, build it, and open a pull request. An adversarial review agent merges it, sends it back, or asks me. Agents run a full build and more than 600 end-to-end Playwright tests before every pull request, and a clean independent run gates each store release.
- **Moved the pipeline's rules from instructions to enforcement:** GitHub rulesets require pull requests with no bypass, code owners approve edits to the agents' guardrails, and Builder and Reviewer bots act under separate identities. CI runs secret scanning, static analysis, a dependency audit, and a workflow linter that found five real problems on day one.
- **Wrote a threat model for agents that read untrusted input:** 14 threats mapped to the OWASP LLM Top 10, each defense marked enforced or only instructed. Tracing the support email path by hand found a real gap.
- **Extended agents past the code:** monthly product, UX, accessibility, and security reviews that file scored issues; support email triage with replies I approve; App Store screenshots; and narrated sprint review videos.
- **Automated releases:** signed iPhone builds go to TestFlight from the cloud with no Mac involved, and Android builds ship nightly. Its reusable Claude Code plugins are public on my GitHub.

AI side projects since 2024: multi-agent writing pipelines (crewAI, then Claude and OpenAI structured outputs), document summarization with embeddings and FAISS, a ReAct agent experiment, and a text-to-video pipeline.

How it's built and governed, in two blog series: ai-delivery-team and ai-governance on deanphillips.dev

EXPERIENCE

Gateway First Senior IT .NET Developer 2026 - Present

- Modernizing legacy .NET applications and deploying them to the cloud.

Energy World Net Software Development Lead 2025 - 2026

- **Pioneered agentic development at the company:** first lead to adopt agentic coding, building Claude Code and Codex skills and commands that captured the company's standards and ran automatically on related tasks. Packaged and demoed them so the other two development teams could adopt them, a major reason the on-the-job training initiative shipped on time.

- **Opened a new revenue opportunity with on-the-job training:** led development of an on-the-job training (OJT) module for the operator qualification platform that lets mentors review and sign off on OJT activities completed by their assigned mentees. Built at the request of larger clients, it opened a new revenue opportunity for the product.
- **Led the team through BMAD adoption and expanded AI beyond engineering:** mentored the team once the company standardized on BMAD, extended AI-assisted workflows to product and QA, and wrote BMAD architecture documents on the architect's behalf.
- **Trusted with local architecture decisions:** led a team of three (two of them senior developers) and owned architecture decisions within the team's scope.

Heartland Payment Systems Solutions Architect 2022 - 2025

- **Demoed an AI payroll assistant at a company AI conference:** built a chat assistant with MCP tools modeled on the payroll API (stubbed for the demo) and read-only database queries. A user could say "update my withholdings to married" and it would ask for missing details and confirm before submitting; support staff could query payroll data and chart it.
- **Modernized front-end architecture:** led the conversion of a monolithic Angular UI into microfrontends aligned with team journeys, so teams depended on each other less and could deploy faster on their own.
- **Moved from DevOps to DevSecOps:** added SonarQube, OWASP Dependency-Check, and Trivy to CI/CD pipelines. As security champion, helped teams fix what those tools found.
- **Automated a multi-week manual process:** tax and compensation updates now run from Docker images hosted in Azure, which cut errors and kept updates on time.
- **Stabilized the payroll system:** created and ran a technical backlog that raised Net Promoter Score by 31 points and cut major incidents from double digits to zero.
- **Improved performance and integrations:** made an employee self-service app up to 90% faster by moving its data access from WCF to a Backend-for-Frontend with Dapper, and moved the FedEx integration from SOAP to REST.
- **Protected sensitive data:** oversaw a key rotation policy and the re-encryption of large volumes of sensitive data with custom-built tools to stay compliant with industry standards.

Heartland Payment Systems Senior Software Engineer 2020 - 2022

- **Worked across a large payroll codebase:** over a million lines in more than 100 repositories covering payroll, gross-to-net, tax, and compliance, keeping practices consistent across about a dozen Scrum teams.
- **Shipped payroll features:** implemented the COVID CARES Act provisions, added multi-factor authentication with Azure AD B2C, and unified multiple user logins into a single email-based login.
- **Improved architecture:** served on an architecture committee for a fragile system, and introduced microservices for shipping and billing using Clean Architecture, CQRS, and DDD. Set up many Azure DevOps pipelines.

CoreLogic (formerly Mercury Network) Senior Professional Software Engineer 2018 - 2020

- **Architected microservices:** refactored a large monolithic notification system into microservices with .NET Core and RabbitMQ, and delivered features and fixes for a public-facing ASP.NET application in two-week Scrum sprints.
- **Built CI/CD for shared libraries:** a build-server-agnostic Cake pipeline for in-house NuGet packages, with semantic versioning from git history and stable and pre-release channels on Nexus.
- **Raised code quality:** added about 4,000 test cases across six legacy applications and services in the first year, bringing in NHibernate, Cypress, Moq, Karma, and Jasmine.
- **Led a winning hackathon team:** led five engineers in a company-wide hackathon across three cities, building an automatic onboarding solution (two Angular apps and .NET Core APIs) in three days. Won 1st place for Best New Product or Feature, 2nd for Best Technical Solution, and 3rd for Biggest Impact.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

- **Delaware Nation Industries, Tinker AFB, Senior Java Developer and Scrum Master (2016 - 2018).** Led the rewrite of 72 ABW SC's applications from Struts 1 to Spring Security, Spring Data JPA, Hibernate, and AngularJS, with two-factor authentication, plus unit and integration testing.
- **Sumaria Systems, then CSI (now Delaware Nation Industries), Tinker AFB (2012 - 2015).** .NET Developer, promoted to Senior and Scrum Master. Moved Classic ASP apps to ASP.NET and automated inventory reporting.
- **Ensco Inc. (BAE Systems), Software Engineer (2005 - 2011).** Led test automation teams of up to 25 engineers across sites for life-critical avionics software, with tools in C, Assembly, Ada, and JOVIAL (DO-178B).

EDUCATION

Broome Community College Associate of Science in Computer Science, Phi Theta Kappa honor society 2009